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📍 Hamburg, Germany

# Aliaksei Yaletski

Founding CTO · Engineering Manager · Tech Lead

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**Hands-on engineering leader** with two decades of experience. My work centers on building **high-autonomy teams** with **strong engineering culture** and **product ownership**. I see team structure, processes, and architecture as parts of the product and evolve them together. My technical expertise ranges from deterministic game logic in C++ to cloud-based payment systems in Python, and from code analysis to AI-based systems.

## Hire Me When

### You start a product from zero

I'll bootstrap the team, architecture, and processes so we can validate hypotheses early and scale or pivot with less rework. I'll prototype where needed to inform design decisions.

### You need long-term product success

I'll evolve the team, architecture, and processes in line with long-term goals and risks. I'll establish knowledge flow, quality automation, and high-frequency delivery required for sustained growth.

## Work Style

### As a manager

I foster self-governed, self-regulated, remote-first teams with transparent decision-making and asynchronous workflows.

### As a technical leader

I stay directly involved in architecture and critical systems, and mentor through shared ownership, design work, and deep code review.

## Work

### 2024-2026 Professional sabbatical

R&D

Technical Writing

Python

TypeScript

Rust

PostgreSQL

LLMs

Read [the full report](#) on my blog.

- Created [Feeds Fun](#), a news reader with LLM-based tagging — **nearly 400 GitHub stars**.
- **Refined engineering management approach** via [essays on team autonomy and scientific practices](#).
- **Built AI coding-agent harness tools**: [Donna](#), [DepMesh](#) — published [findings](#).
- Completed the [World Builders](#) program in entertainment IP development — published [essays](#).

### 2022-2023 Multi-provider payments platform for Palta portfolio startups

Palta

Engineering Manager

Tech Lead

Engineering Processes

Hiring

Onboarding

Mentoring

AWS

Python

TypeScript

PostgreSQL

Redis

FastAPI

**Led the design and delivery of a payments platform from concept to production**, covering subscriptions, entitlement management, discounting, unified analytics, admin tooling, SDKs, and resilient payment flows with support for disputes, refunds, provider fallback, and failure recovery.

- The solution has been successfully integrated into 3 portfolio companies.
- Built and led a remote-first core team of 7 engineers.
- Hired, onboarded, mentored, and gradually transferred system ownership to new team members.
- Led development from concept to production, ensuring stable operations during the holiday season.
- Established [an RFC-driven approach for evolving architecture and engineering processes](#).
- Designed resilient payment flows with idempotency, safe retries, provider fallback, and state recovery.
- Established a delivery process with multiple releases per week and on-demand feature shipping.
- Identified concurrency bugs in major Python libraries ([redis-py](#), [psycopg](#)), including [one that caused an OpenAI outage](#), and prevented them from affecting our systems.

## 2019-2021 Professional sabbatical

Technical Writing

Game Design

Python

Julia

Deep Neural Networks

Read [the full report](#) on my blog.

- Strengthened expertise in advanced backend architecture, code analysis, and quality control.
- Refined my game-design approach through reflection on practical experience and literature.
- Explored the Julia programming language.
- Refreshed mathematical analysis and deep neural network fundamentals.
- Published 100+ essays on technology, gamedev, and thinking — longer than the first Harry Potter novel.

## 2017-2019 Mobile game **My Cafe** — 50M+ installs as of September 2021

Melsoft  
Games

Tech Lead

Linux

Python

PostgreSQL

Redis

Twisted

Django

Graphite

Prometheus

Grafana

Ansible

**Owned backend architecture and core service development**, modernized legacy systems for scale and stability, served as a key technical advisor on architecture and algorithm design.

- Optimized game backend to handle 1.5M RPM (25k RPS) with stable latency and low error rates.
- Stabilized server-side payment-processing and analytics logic, reducing payment-related errors to zero.
- Implemented scalable profile sharding, reducing database load by an order of magnitude.
- Developed support for GDPR on short notice.
- Adapted server-side logic for Chinese requirements.
- Introduced the practice of writing automated tests.
- Together with an analyst, developed a marketing campaign system and an A/B testing system.

## 2015-2017 Mobile games **Toy Defense 1, 2, and 3**

Melsoft  
Games

Tech Lead

Hiring

Onboarding

Mentoring

Linux

Python

MySQL

Redis

Twisted

Django

Fabric

Graphite

Grafana

**Fully owned the unified backend of 3 games.** As an expert, consulted colleagues on infrastructure, architecture, and algorithmic questions.

- Resurrected the legacy game backend to an operational state.
- Developed a payment service, which was also reused by the neighboring team.
- Introduced practices for automated testing, CI/CD, and metrics collection.
- Migrated the project from SVN to Git.
- Together with an analyst, developed game metrics collection and marketing campaign systems.

## 2012-2015 Browser text-based MMO game **"The Tale"**

The Tale

Founder

Engineering Processes

Team Formation

R&D

Game Design

Marketing

Monetization

Community Management

Volunteer Coordination

Linux

Python

JavaScript

PostgreSQL

Redis

RabbitMQ

Django

**Developed my own product from scratch**, from prototyping through release, operation, and shutdown. Played all roles, from backend and frontend development to game design, community management, and marketing.

- With only a Russian localization, the game reached 90k+ trial players, 30k+ registered players, 2k+ paying players; with up to 5k MAU and 2k DAU at peak.
- Assembled a core team and organized volunteers who helped in the development of the game.
- Designed advanced game systems: player-shaped persistent world, player-driven economy and governance, autonomous NPCs with dynamic personalities, player-authored entity lore.
- Implemented automated quality control, which allowed development without dedicated QA.
- Developed advanced procedural generation of [Russian text](#), [quests](#), and the world map.
- Open-sourced [the code](#) and [the game lore](#).

## 2010-2012 Web portal **World of Tanks**, meta-game "Clan Wars"

Wargaming

Senior Developer

Mentoring

Linux

Python

JavaScript

PostgreSQL

Memcached

RabbitMQ

Django

jQuery

**Owned the code of the whole web portal:** registration, player & clan profiles, clan management, player statistics, ratings, tournaments, the meta-game for clans, news, i18n, etc.

- Together with the team, completely switched the technology stack from client-side C++ to a Python backend and developed the portal for one of the most successful online games.
- In 2 years, grew ownership from several subsystems to the entire portal.
- Together with a colleague, designed and implemented the GUI for a web-based clan meta-game.
- Designed requirements for CAPTCHA and password quality checks and implemented them.

## 2009-2010 Real-time strategy game **Order of War**

Wargaming

Middle Developer

Windows

C++

internal game engine

**Optimized code and developed game logic**, including critical GUI elements.

- During probation, doubled command-queue throughput between the game logic and graphics engine.
- Designed and implemented core unit-formation UI, central to gameplay and UX.

## 2008-2009 Automated migration of Linux systems from physical machines to VMs

ltransition

Middle Developer

Linux

Perl

C

Xen

VMware

**Implemented automatic virtual-hardware configuration** according to physical-machine specs.

- Introduced practices of automated testing.

## 2007-2008 GUI for VoIP telephone

ltransition

Junior Developer

Windows

C++

wxWidgets

## Education

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### 2004-2009 — Specialist (equivalent to an MSc), Systems Engineering

Belarusian State University of Informatics and Radioelectronics

Department of Artificial Intelligence, Faculty of Information Technologies and Control

## Languages

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Russian native

English fluent

## Code examples

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[tiendil/feeds.fun](#)

News reader with LLM-based tagging and rule-based ranking.

## Interesting Facts

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- All em dashes in this CV are human-made.
- Won a second diploma (3rd place) in the quarter-final of ACM ICPC Western Subregion 2006.
- I regularly publish [long-form essays](#) about complex topics I have studied and questions where I have a strong opinion.